

# Lithuania



## White storks

The national bird of Lithuania is the white stork. There are more than 22,000 stork nests across the country.



## Saint Jonas's Festival

On June 24, Lithuanians celebrate this midsummer festival by singing, dancing, and wearing flower wreaths.



## Trakai Island Castle

The picturesque castle sits on an island in Lake Galvė, attached to the lakeshore by two bridges.

Lithuania is the **largest** of the **Baltic states**. It was the last country in Europe to adopt Christianity. Like Estonia and Latvia, it **gained independence** from Russia in **1991**.



- 25,212 sq miles (65,300 sq km)
- 2.7 million
- Vilnius
- Lithuanian, Russian

# Latvia



According to one legend, the flag is the blood-soaked sheet of a Latvian soldier.

## Vibrant Riga

At the heart of the capital city of Riga is a medieval Old Town, known for its striking architecture and bustling markets.

## Latvian symbol

Latvia's national flower is the daisy, which grows wild in summer and is featured in floral displays and bouquets.



Latvia is known for its **forests, beaches**, and the **Venta Rapid**—the widest waterfall in Europe. The city of **Ventspils** in the country's northwest is one of the **busiest ports** on the **Baltic Sea**.

- 24,938 sq miles (64,589 sq km)
- 1.9 million
- Riga
- Latvian, Russian

